Townsend recalls: "The first unit shot on the cranes for one day, with our actors on location. Then we recreated it on a stage set, or at least certain bits of it. We then recreated that environment *again* digitally and used that CG environment for all of those green-screen shots.

"In those shots where we used the practical photography, like helicopter shots—the second-unit establishing shots—we had to remove Wilmington in the distance, and make it look like we were on an island with a bridge and a distant landscape. So a lot of that stuff has had digital matte-painting work put in, as well as atmospherics.

"And then we've got the Extremis characters running around. They were originally going to be shot using stuntmen, but we ended up with CG digital doubles because so much of the environment is CG—digital characters that we created in the computer. We've got full digital characters out there, and we're making them glow with the same Extremis effect established earlier in the movie. So whenever you see our principal actors fighting or walking or jumping or running, you'll always see action going on behind them in the deep background, and all of that is CG."